broker, found that during the start of the pandemic in March 2020, men were twice as likely than women to withdraw money during the downturn of the market, solidifying their losses. Whereas 95 per cent of women made no adjustments to their portfolio.

There's a popular phrase in the world of investing called 'buy and hold', and it's popular for a reason.

Female investors tend to invest for the long term and don't change their investing strategy easily. It's easy to get affected by the hype of FOMO or fear when the market drops, as mentioned earlier. But investors in training know that, on average, the stock market returns 7 to 10 per cent, and if anything is suggesting a guaranteed return of more than this, it is unlikely to be true. They are also aware that if they have a solid investing strategy that includes diversifying in broad market funds, buying and holding and checking their portfolios less frequently, there's less to worry about. It goes back to the idea of starting out with a solid foundation based on knowledge and research. Investors in training know that a house will crumble if it doesn't start out with good foundations.

When it comes to marital status, the pattern is still the same: according to a Wells Fargo report in 2019 'Women & Investing', single women trade 27 per cent less frequently than single men. Interestingly enough, men's trading activities quieten down when they begin sharing finances with a female partner.

This tendency to buy and hold could be attributed to female investors being more risk aware, and therefore deciding to engage in further research before investing. Female investors are also more likely to seek financial help (a bit like the stereotype of women being more likely to ask for directions when lost) if they have queries.

A study led by the Haas School of Business and UC Davis Graduate School of Management found male investors tend to be more overconfident in their investments, which leads to more frequent trading, and therefore lower returns.

Investors in training, regardless of what gender they identify with, can learn from these behaviours and understand the importance of trading less frequently and seeking advice if they are unsure.